

A NARROW-CONVERGENCE EXISTENCE PROOF WITH PARAMETER-MOMENT REGULARIZATION

ABSTRACT. This note formulates and proves an existence theorem for a modified version of the unbounded-parameter sparse-neural-network problem from the thesis. The modification is the addition of a coercive parameter-moment term

$$\beta \int_{\mathbb{R}^{d+1}} (1 + |\omega|^p) d|\mu|(\omega).$$

The moment bound supplies the tightness that is missing from the original location-blind penalty. Signed Prokhorov compactness then gives narrow convergence, while the condition that the moment order dominate the growth of the activation gives uniform integrability of the network atoms. The note also records a finite-support consequence under an additional global H^1 -growth assumption of the activation function. The result concerns the modified objective; it is not a topology-only reproof of existence for the original objective.

1. PROBLEM AND NOTATION

Let $D \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ be a bounded Lipschitz domain, let $V \in H^1(D)$, and set

$$\Omega := \mathbb{R}^{d+1}, \quad \omega = (a, b) \in \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}.$$

Given a continuous activation profile $\rho : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, define the ridge atom

$$K(\omega)(x) := \sigma(x, \omega) := \rho(a \cdot x + b), \quad x \in D.$$

For $p > 0$, introduce the coercive weight

$$w_p(\omega) := 1 + |\omega|^p$$

and the weighted space of finite signed Radon measures

$$\mathcal{M}_p(\Omega) := \left\{ \mu \in \mathcal{M}(\Omega) : \Psi_p(\mu) := \int_{\Omega} w_p(\omega) d|\mu|(\omega) < \infty \right\}.$$

Definition 1.1 (Narrow convergence for signed measures). We write $\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \mu$ if

$$\int_{\Omega} f d\mu_n \longrightarrow \int_{\Omega} f d\mu \quad \text{for every } f \in C_b(\Omega).$$

Suppose for the moment that

$$(1) \quad |\rho(z)| \leq C_\rho(1 + |z|)^k \quad (z \in \mathbb{R})$$

for some $k \geq 0$. Since D is bounded, there is a constant C_D such that

$$(2) \quad \|K(\omega)\|_{L^2(D)} \leq C_D(1 + |\omega|)^k.$$

The map $K : \Omega \rightarrow L^2(D)$ is continuous: if $\omega_n \rightarrow \omega$, then all preactivations $a_n \cdot x + b_n$ remain in one compact interval for $x \in D$, and uniform continuity of ρ on that interval gives $K(\omega_n) \rightarrow K(\omega)$ uniformly on D . If $p > k$ and $\mu \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$, the map $\omega \mapsto K(\omega)$ is Bochner integrable in $L^2(D)$ with respect to μ , and we may define

$$\mathcal{N}\mu := \int_{\Omega} K(\omega) d\mu(\omega) \in L^2(D).$$

As in the thesis, the gradient is understood distributionally and the fidelity is

$$L(\mu) := \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2} \|\mathcal{N}\mu - V\|_{L^2(D)}^2 + \frac{1}{2} \|\nabla(\mathcal{N}\mu) - \nabla V\|_{L^2(D)}^2, & \mathcal{N}\mu \in H^1(D), \\ +\infty, & \mathcal{N}\mu \notin H^1(D). \end{cases}$$

Let $\mu = \mu_{\text{cont}} + \mu_{\text{atom}}$ denote its continuous/atomic decomposition, where

$$\mu_{\text{atom}} = \sum_{\omega \in \text{atom } \mu} \mu(\{\omega\}) \delta_{\omega}.$$

For a function $\phi : \mathbb{R}_+ \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_+$, define the thesis penalty

$$\Phi_1(\mu) := \|\mu_{\text{cont}}\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} + \sum_{\omega \in \text{atom } \mu} \phi(|\mu(\{\omega\})|).$$

Assumption 1.2 (Penalty assumptions). The function ϕ satisfies the thesis assumptions:

- (1) $\phi(0) = 0$, ϕ is differentiable on $\mathbb{R}_+$, and $\phi'(0) = 1$;
- (2) ϕ is concave, nondecreasing, and coercive.

For $\alpha, \beta > 0$, the modified objective is

$$(3) \quad J_{\beta,p}(\mu) := L(\mu) + \alpha \Phi_1(\mu) + \beta \Psi_p(\mu), \quad \mu \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega),$$

and it is extended by $+\infty$ to $\mathcal{M}(\Omega) \setminus \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$.

Remark 1.3 (This is a genuine model modification). For a finite network

$$\mu = \sum_{j=1}^N c_j \delta_{\omega_j},$$

the new term is

$$\beta \Psi_p(\mu) = \beta \sum_{j=1}^N |c_j| (1 + |\omega_j|^p).$$

Thus the cost of a distant neuron is weighted by the magnitude of its output coefficient. The term is a weighted total-variation penalty, or equivalently a parameter-moment penalty. It is not generated automatically by the narrow topology. The choice $1 + |\omega|^p$, rather than $(1 + |\omega|)^p$, is immaterial for compactness but is smoother at the origin when $p > 1$ and agrees with the standard polynomial moment used in the cited literature.

2. MAIN EXISTENCE THEOREM

Theorem 2.1 (Existence by the narrow direct method). *Assume that $D \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ is bounded and Lipschitz, $V \in H^1(D)$, Assumption 1.2 holds, and $\rho \in C(\mathbb{R})$ satisfies the polynomial growth bound (1) for some $k \geq 0$. If*

$$p > k, \quad \alpha > 0, \quad \beta > 0,$$

then the modified problem

$$\inf_{\mu \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)} J_{\beta,p}(\mu)$$

admits at least one global minimizer.

The proof uses three elementary consequences of the moment bound.

2.1. Moment bounds give narrow compactness.

Lemma 2.2 (Tightness and signed Prokhorov compactness). *Let $(\mu_n) \subset \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$ satisfy*

$$\sup_n \Psi_p(\mu_n) \leq M < \infty.$$

Then (μ_n) has a narrowly convergent subsequence.

Proof. Since $w_p \geq 1$,

$$\|\mu_n\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} = |\mu_n|(\Omega) \leq \Psi_p(\mu_n) \leq M.$$

Moreover, for every $R > 0$,

$$(4) \quad |\mu_n|(\Omega \setminus B_R) \leq \frac{1}{1 + R^p} \int_{\Omega \setminus B_R} w_p d|\mu_n| \leq \frac{M}{1 + R^p}.$$

Hence the variations $|\mu_n|$ are uniformly tight.

Write the Jordan decomposition as $\mu_n = \mu_n^+ - \mu_n^-$. Both nonnegative families (μ_n^+) and (μ_n^-) are uniformly bounded in mass and uniformly tight because $\mu_n^\pm \leq |\mu_n|$. Prokhorov's theorem, applied twice and with a diagonal subsequence, gives nonnegative finite measures λ^+, λ^- such that

$$\mu_n^+ \rightharpoonup_n \lambda^+, \quad \mu_n^- \rightharpoonup_n \lambda^-.$$

It follows that

$$\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \lambda^+ - \lambda^-.$$

The pair (λ^+, λ^-) need not be the Jordan decomposition of the limit, but this is irrelevant for compactness. $\square$

2.2. Lower semicontinuity of the moment.

Lemma 2.3 (Narrow lower semicontinuity of Ψ_p). *If $\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \mu$, then*

$$\Psi_p(\mu) \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_p(\mu_n).$$

Proof. For $m \in \mathbb{N}$ set

$$g_m(\omega) := \min\{w_p(\omega), m\}.$$

Then $g_m \in C_b(\Omega)$ and $g_m \geq 0$. For every finite signed measure ν ,

$$\int_{\Omega} g_m d|\nu| = \|g_m \nu\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} = \sup_{\substack{f \in C_0(\Omega) \\ \|f\|_{\infty} \leq 1}} \int_{\Omega} f g_m d\nu.$$

If $\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \mu$, then $\int f g_m d\mu_n \rightarrow \int f g_m d\mu$ for every $f \in C_0(\Omega)$, because $f g_m \in C_0(\Omega) \subset C_b(\Omega)$. Taking the supremum gives

$$\int_{\Omega} g_m d|\mu| \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_{\Omega} g_m d|\mu_n| \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_p(\mu_n).$$

Finally, $g_m \uparrow w_p$ pointwise, so monotone convergence and then the supremum over m yield the claim. $\square$

2.3. Continuity of the value operator.

Lemma 2.4 (Uniform moments imply strong value convergence). *Assume (2), let $p > k$, and suppose*

$$\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \mu, \quad \sup_n \Psi_p(\mu_n) \leq M.$$

Then

$$\mathcal{N}\mu_n \longrightarrow \mathcal{N}\mu \quad \text{strongly in } L^2(D).$$

Proof. Lemma 2.3 gives $\Psi_p(\mu) \leq M$. Choose $\chi_R \in C_c(\Omega)$ with

$$0 \leq \chi_R \leq 1, \quad \chi_R = 1 \text{ on } B_R, \quad \text{supp } \chi_R \subset B_{R+1}.$$

The truncated map

$$K_R : \Omega \rightarrow L^2(D), \quad K_R(\omega) := \chi_R(\omega) K(\omega),$$

is continuous and compactly supported. We first claim that

$$(5) \quad \int_{\Omega} K_R d\mu_n \longrightarrow \int_{\Omega} K_R d\mu \quad \text{strongly in } L^2(D).$$

Indeed, a continuous compactly supported Banach-valued map can be approximated uniformly by finite-rank maps of the form

$$F_{\varepsilon}(\omega) = \sum_{j=1}^{J_{\varepsilon}} f_j(\omega) h_j, \quad f_j \in C_c(\Omega), \quad h_j \in L^2(D).$$

This follows by covering the compact image of K_R with finitely many L^2 -balls and using a continuous partition of unity; see Ryan [4, Section 3.2]. Narrow convergence gives

$$\int_{\Omega} F_{\varepsilon} d\mu_n \longrightarrow \int_{\Omega} F_{\varepsilon} d\mu \quad \text{in } L^2(D),$$

because only finitely many scalar integrals are involved. The approximation error is bounded by

$$\left\| \int_{\Omega} (K_R - F_{\varepsilon}) d\mu_n \right\|_{L^2(D)} \leq \|K_R - F_{\varepsilon}\|_{\infty} \|\mu_n\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)},$$

uniformly in n , and similarly for μ . This proves (5).

It remains to remove the cutoff. For $R \geq 1$, $|\omega| > R$, and $p > k$,

$$(1 + |\omega|)^k \leq 2^k R^{k-p} (1 + |\omega|^p).$$

Consequently,

$$\begin{aligned} \left\| \int_{\Omega} (1 - \chi_R) K d\mu_n \right\|_{L^2(D)} &\leq \int_{\Omega \setminus B_R} \|K(\omega)\|_{L^2(D)} d|\mu_n|(\omega) \\ &\leq 2^k C_D R^{k-p} \Psi_p(\mu_n) \\ &\leq 2^k C_D M R^{k-p}. \end{aligned}$$

The same estimate holds for μ . First let $n \rightarrow \infty$ in the truncated integrals and then let $R \rightarrow \infty$. Since $k - p < 0$, the tail estimate tends to zero and the claimed strong convergence follows. $\square$

2.4. Inherited lower semicontinuity of the nonconvex penalty.

Lemma 2.5 (Lower semicontinuity of the thesis penalty). *Under Assumption 1.2, if $\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \mu$, then*

$$\Phi_1(\mu) \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} \Phi_1(\mu_n).$$

Proof. Narrow convergence implies weak-* convergence against $C_0(\Omega)$. The sequential weak-* lower semicontinuity of Φ_1 under Assumption 1.2 is the lower-semicontinuity lemma already proved in the thesis, based on the nonconvex measure-functional theory of Bouchitté and Buttazzo [3]. Hence that result applies without modification. $\square$

2.5. Proof of Theorem 2.1.

Proof of Theorem 2.1. Since $V \in H^1(D)$,

$$J_{\beta,p}(0) = \frac{1}{2} \|V\|_{H^1(D)}^2 < \infty.$$

Choose a minimizing sequence $(\mu_n) \subset \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$ such that $J_{\beta,p}(\mu_n) \leq C$. All three terms in (3) are nonnegative, and therefore

$$\Psi_p(\mu_n) \leq \frac{C}{\beta}.$$

Lemma 2.2 gives, after extracting a subsequence,

$$\mu_n \rightharpoonup_n \bar{\mu}.$$

By Lemma 2.3, $\bar{\mu} \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$ and

$$\Psi_p(\bar{\mu}) \leq \liminf_n \Psi_p(\mu_n).$$

Lemma 2.4 gives

$$(6) \quad \mathcal{N}\mu_n \longrightarrow \mathcal{N}\bar{\mu} \quad \text{strongly in } L^2(D).$$

The bound on the fidelity gives

$$\sup_n \|\nabla(\mathcal{N}\mu_n)\|_{L^2(D)} \leq \|\nabla V\|_{L^2(D)} + \sqrt{2C}.$$

After another extraction,

$$\nabla(\mathcal{N}\mu_n) \rightharpoonup g \quad \text{weakly in } L^2(D)^d$$

for some g . For every $\psi \in C_c^\infty(D)^d$,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_D g \cdot \psi \, dx &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_D \nabla(\mathcal{N}\mu_n) \cdot \psi \, dx \\ &= - \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_D \mathcal{N}\mu_n \operatorname{div} \psi \, dx \\ &= - \int_D \mathcal{N}\bar{\mu} \operatorname{div} \psi \, dx, \end{aligned}$$

where the last step follows from (6). Hence $g = \nabla(\mathcal{N}\bar{\mu})$ distributionally and $\mathcal{N}\bar{\mu} \in H^1(D)$.

The value part of the fidelity is continuous by (6), while the gradient part is weakly lower semicontinuous. Therefore

$$L(\bar{\mu}) \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} L(\mu_n).$$

Lemma 2.5 and Lemma 2.3 give the same inequality for the two regularizers. Combining the three terms,

$$J_{\beta,p}(\bar{\mu}) \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} J_{\beta,p}(\mu_n) = \inf_{\mu \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)} J_{\beta,p}(\mu).$$

Thus $\bar{\mu}$ is a global minimizer. $\square$

3. A FINITE-SUPPORT CONSEQUENCE

The existence theorem only uses growth of the value atoms in $L^2(D)$. To make the thesis's finite-support argument unconditional, the moment must instead dominate the growth of the full H^1 atom.

Assumption 3.1 (H^1 atom growth). The map $K : \Omega \rightarrow H^1(D)$ is continuous and, for some $q \geq 0$,

$$(7) \quad \|K(\omega)\|_{H^1(D)} \leq C_K(1 + |\omega|)^q \quad (\omega \in \Omega).$$

Assumption 3.2 (Strict local concavity). There exist $\gamma > 0$ and $z_0 > 0$ such that

$$\phi'(z_2) - \phi'(z_1) \leq -\gamma(z_2 - z_1) \quad (0 \leq z_1 \leq z_2 \leq z_0).$$

Theorem 3.3 (Finite support without a separate no-escape condition). *Assume Assumptions 1.2, 3.1, and 3.2. Let $p > q$, and let $\bar{\mu} \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$ be a local minimizer of $J_{\beta,p}$ with respect to the total-variation norm, with $J_{\beta,p}(\bar{\mu}) < \infty$. Then $\bar{\mu}$ is finitely supported.*

Proof. Set

$$r := \mathcal{N}\bar{\mu} - V \in H^1(D)$$

and define the dual field

$$P(\omega) := \langle r, K(\omega) \rangle_{H^1(D)}.$$

For the ridge atom $K(\omega)(x) = \rho(a \cdot x + b)$, with $\omega = (a, b)$ and differentiable ρ , this reads

$$P(a, b) = \int_D r(x) \rho(a \cdot x + b) \, dx + \int_D \nabla r(x) \cdot a \rho'(a \cdot x + b) \, dx.$$

Thus $P(\omega)$ is the first-order change of the fidelity produced by inserting the atom at ω . By Cauchy–Schwarz and Assumption 3.1, P is continuous and

$$(8) \quad |P(\omega)| \leq \|r\|_{H^1(D)} \|K(\omega)\|_{H^1(D)} \leq C_P(1 + |\omega|)^q, \quad C_P := C_K \|r\|_{H^1(D)} < \infty.$$

The constant C_P may depend on the fixed minimizer through its residual $r = \mathcal{N}\bar{\mu} - V$, but it does not depend on ω .

Step 1: first-order conditions. Coefficient perturbations by $\pm t\delta_\omega$ give

$$(9) \quad |P(\omega)| \leq \alpha + \beta w_p(\omega) \quad (\omega \notin \text{atom } \bar{\mu}).$$

If $c = \bar{\mu}(\{\omega\}) \neq 0$, perturbing the existing coefficient in both directions gives

$$(10) \quad P(\omega) = -[\alpha\phi'(|c|) + \beta w_p(\omega)] \operatorname{sign}(c).$$

Finally, applying the two scaling directions to compact restrictions of $\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}$ and then exhausting Ω gives

$$(11) \quad P(\omega) = -[\alpha + \beta w_p(\omega)] \operatorname{sign}(\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}})(\omega) \quad \text{for } |\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}| \text{-a.e. } \omega.$$

These calculations are the thesis's directional-derivative proof with the additional derivative

$$\left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_{t=0} \Psi_p(\bar{\mu} + tu)$$

included. All directions used above are compactly supported, so their networks lie in $H^1(D)$ by Assumption 3.1.

Step 2: the support is automatically confined. At an atom, taking absolute values in (10) and using $\phi' \geq 0$ gives

$$|P(\omega)| = \alpha\phi'(|c|) + \beta w_p(\omega) \geq \beta w_p(\omega).$$

Likewise, (11) gives

$$|P(\omega)| = \alpha + \beta w_p(\omega) \geq \beta w_p(\omega) \quad \text{for } |\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}| \text{-a.e. } \omega.$$

Consequently $|\bar{\mu}|$ is concentrated on

$$E := \{\omega \in \Omega : \beta w_p(\omega) \leq |P(\omega)|\}.$$

The set E is closed because P and w_p are continuous. We now show explicitly that it is bounded. Let $\omega \in E$ and set $R := |\omega| \geq 1$. Since $w_p(\omega) = 1 + R^p$, (8) yields

$$\beta R^p \leq \beta(1 + R^p) \leq |P(\omega)| \leq C_P(1 + R)^q \leq 2^q C_P R^q.$$

Therefore

$$R^{p-q} \leq \frac{2^q C_P}{\beta}.$$

Because $p - q > 0$, this inequality cannot hold for arbitrarily large R ; indeed,

$$E \subset \overline{B}_{R_*}, \quad R_* := \max \left\{ 1, \left(\frac{2^q C_P}{\beta} \right)^{1/(p-q)} \right\}.$$

Thus E is closed and bounded, hence compact. Since $|\bar{\mu}|(\Omega \setminus E) = 0$ and E is closed,

$$\operatorname{supp} \bar{\mu} \subset E.$$

In words, the largest possible fidelity gain grows at most like R^q , whereas the moment cost grows like R^p . The strict inequality $p > q$ makes the cost dominate at infinity. This is the step that replaces the thesis's separate no-escape condition; when $\beta = 0$, the set E is all of Ω and this confinement argument disappears.

Step 3: the continuous part vanishes. Suppose, for contradiction, that the positive continuous part $\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}^+$ is nonzero; the negative case is analogous. By (11), choose

$$\hat{\omega} \in \operatorname{supp} \bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}^+, \quad \bar{\mu}(\{\hat{\omega}\}) = 0, \quad P(\hat{\omega}) + \beta w_p(\hat{\omega}) = -\alpha.$$

For $\delta > 0$, let

$$\nu_\delta := \bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}}^+|_{B_\delta(\hat{\omega})}, \quad m_\delta := \nu_\delta(\Omega),$$

and merge this mass onto its center:

$$\mu_\delta := \bar{\mu} - \nu_\delta + m_\delta \delta_{\hat{\omega}}.$$

Then $m_\delta > 0$, $m_\delta \rightarrow 0$, and $\|\mu_\delta - \bar{\mu}\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} \leq 2m_\delta \rightarrow 0$.

Because the support lies in a compact set and $K : \Omega \rightarrow H^1(D)$ is continuous, there is a modulus $\eta(\delta) \rightarrow 0$ such that

$$\|\mathcal{N}(\mu_\delta - \bar{\mu})\|_{H^1(D)} \leq \eta(\delta)m_\delta.$$

The quadratic fidelity has the exact expansion

$$L(\mu_\delta) - L(\bar{\mu}) = \int_{\Omega} P d(\mu_\delta - \bar{\mu}) + \frac{1}{2} \|\mathcal{N}(\mu_\delta - \bar{\mu})\|_{H^1(D)}^2.$$

The linear fidelity term and the change of the moment cancel together:

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_{\Omega} P d(\mu_\delta - \bar{\mu}) + \beta [\Psi_p(\mu_\delta) - \Psi_p(\bar{\mu})] \\ &= m_\delta [P(\hat{\omega}) + \beta w_p(\hat{\omega})] - \int_{B_\delta(\hat{\omega})} [P + \beta w_p] d\nu_\delta = 0. \end{aligned}$$

The moved mass was continuous and creates one new atom, so

$$\Phi_1(\mu_\delta) - \Phi_1(\bar{\mu}) = \phi(m_\delta) - m_\delta.$$

Assumption 3.2 and $\phi'(0) = 1$ imply, for sufficiently small m_δ ,

$$\phi(m_\delta) - m_\delta \leq -\frac{\gamma}{2} m_\delta^2.$$

Consequently,

$$J_{\beta,p}(\mu_\delta) - J_{\beta,p}(\bar{\mu}) \leq \frac{1}{2} [\eta(\delta)^2 - \alpha\gamma] m_\delta^2 < 0$$

for small δ , contradicting local minimality. Thus $\bar{\mu}_{\text{cont}} = 0$.

Step 4: there are only finitely many atoms. Suppose instead that $\bar{\mu}$ has infinitely many atoms. Since their support is contained in the compact set E , there are distinct atoms $\omega_i \rightarrow \hat{\omega}$ whose coefficients have a common sign. Reversing signs if necessary, write

$$c_i := \bar{\mu}(\{\omega_i\}) > 0.$$

Finite total variation gives $c_i \rightarrow 0$. By (10), continuity of P and w_p , and $\phi'(c_i) \rightarrow \phi'(0) = 1$,

$$P(\hat{\omega}) = -\alpha - \beta w_p(\hat{\omega}).$$

For $N \in \mathbb{N}$ set

$$C_N := \sum_{i=N}^{\infty} c_i, \quad \delta_N := \sup_{i \geq N} |\omega_i - \hat{\omega}|,$$

and merge the tail:

$$\mu_N := \bar{\mu} - \sum_{i=N}^{\infty} c_i \delta_{\omega_i} + C_N \delta_{\hat{\omega}}.$$

Then $C_N \rightarrow 0$, $\delta_N \rightarrow 0$, and $\|\mu_N - \bar{\mu}\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} \leq 2C_N \rightarrow 0$. Uniform continuity of K on the compact support gives

$$\|\mathcal{N}(\mu_N - \bar{\mu})\|_{H^1(D)} \leq \eta(\delta_N) C_N.$$

At a pre-existing atom at $\hat{\omega}$, the triangle inequality gives the upper bounds

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi_p(\mu_N) - \Psi_p(\bar{\mu}) &\leq - \sum_{i=N}^{\infty} c_i w_p(\omega_i) + C_N w_p(\hat{\omega}), \\ \Phi_1(\mu_N) - \Phi_1(\bar{\mu}) &\leq - \sum_{i=N}^{\infty} \phi(c_i) + \phi(C_N). \end{aligned}$$

Combining these estimates with the exact quadratic expansion of L and the weighted atom condition gives

$$\begin{aligned} J_{\beta,p}(\mu_N) - J_{\beta,p}(\bar{\mu}) &\leq -\alpha \sum_{i=N}^{\infty} [\phi(c_i) - c_i \phi'(c_i)] \\ &\quad - \alpha [C_N - \phi(C_N)] + \frac{1}{2} \eta(\delta_N)^2 C_N^2. \end{aligned}$$

Concavity and $\phi(0) = 0$ give $\phi(c) - c\phi'(c) \geq 0$. Assumption 3.2 gives $C_N - \phi(C_N) \geq \frac{\gamma}{2}C_N^2$ for large N . Therefore

$$J_{\beta,p}(\mu_N) - J_{\beta,p}(\bar{\mu}) \leq \frac{1}{2} [\eta(\delta_N)^2 - \alpha\gamma] C_N^2 < 0$$

for large N , again contradicting local minimality. The atomic support is therefore finite. $\square$

Corollary 3.4 (Existence of a finite network). *Assume the hypotheses of Theorem 2.1, Assumptions 3.1 and 3.2, and*

$$p > \max\{k, q\}.$$

Then the modified problem admits a finitely supported global minimizer. In particular, the existence and finite-support conclusions compose without a separate no-escape condition.

Proof. Theorem 2.1 supplies a global minimizer $\bar{\mu} \in \mathcal{M}_p(\Omega)$ with finite objective. A global minimizer is a total-variation local minimizer, and $p > q$ allows Theorem 3.3 to be applied to $\bar{\mu}$. $\square$

4. ACTIVATION EXPONENTS

The following safe exponents follow from elementary pointwise bounds on a bounded domain. The exponent k controls the value atom in $L^2(D)$ and is enough for Theorem 2.1; the exponent q controls the full atom in $H^1(D)$ and is needed for Theorem 3.3.

activation	k	safe q	one choice giving existence and finite support
$\tanh z$	0	1	$p > 1$
e^{-z^2}	0	1	$p > 1$
$\log(1 + e^z)$	1	1	$p > 1$
$(z_+)^m$	m	m	$p > m$

For bounded activations such as $\tanh$ and the Gaussian, existence alone requires only $p > 0$. The safer condition $p > 1$ is shown in the table because it also dominates the elementary global H^1 growth estimate.

5. WHAT FAILS WHEN THE MOMENT TERM IS ABSENT

Example 5.1 (Loss of narrow compactness). Let $\omega_n = (0, n)$ and $\mu_n = \delta_{\omega_n}$. Then

$$\|\mu_n\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} = 1, \quad \Phi_1(\mu_n) = \phi(1),$$

so the original regularizer is uniformly bounded. Nevertheless, (μ_n) has no narrowly convergent subsequence. Indeed, compactly supported test functions force every putative limit to be zero, while the bounded continuous test function 1 preserves the mass:

$$\int_{\Omega} 1 d\mu_n = 1.$$

Thus bounded mass without a location-coercive term does not give narrow compactness.

Example 5.2 (Narrow convergence does not control an unbounded dictionary). For softplus, let

$$\rho(z) = \log(1 + e^z), \quad \omega_n = (0, n), \quad \mu_n = \frac{1}{\rho(n)} \delta_{\omega_n}.$$

Then $\mu_n \rightarrow_n 0$, because $\|\mu_n\|_{\mathcal{M}(\Omega)} = \rho(n)^{-1} \rightarrow 0$. However,

$$\mathcal{N}\mu_n \equiv 1 \quad \text{while} \quad \mathcal{N}0 = 0.$$

For $V \equiv 1$, the original objective satisfies

$$L(\mu_n) = 0, \quad \Phi_1(\mu_n) = \phi(\rho(n)^{-1}) \rightarrow 0,$$

which yields the nonattainment mechanism recorded in the thesis. With the moment term,

$$\Psi_p(\mu_n) = \frac{1 + n^p}{\rho(n)} \asymp n^{p-1},$$

so every $p > 1$ prices out this escape.

6. RELATION TO THE LITERATURE

The compactness mechanism is classical: Prokhorov’s theorem converts uniform tightness and a total-mass bound into narrow precompactness. A coercive moment bound supplies tightness through the elementary estimate (4); see, for example, Bogachev [2].

In the neural-network literature, Bartolucci, Carioni, Iglesias, Korolev, Naldi, and Vigogna [1] study signed measures on unbounded parameter spaces and explicitly regularize by total variation and parameter moments. Their Theorem 3.7 proves compactness in the stronger unbalanced Kantorovich–Rubinstein norm for moments of order strictly larger than one. The present proof only seeks narrow compactness, so the compactness step itself needs any coercive moment. The additional restriction $p > k$ comes instead from uniform integrability of a dictionary growing like $|\omega|^k$.

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